**Listing 8.20 Asking the engine to explain the score**

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "explain": true,
  "_source": false,
  "query": {
    "match": {
      "title": "Lord"
    }
  }
}
```

The `explain` attribute is set at the same level as the `query` object. The result of this query is interesting, as figure 8.5 shows.

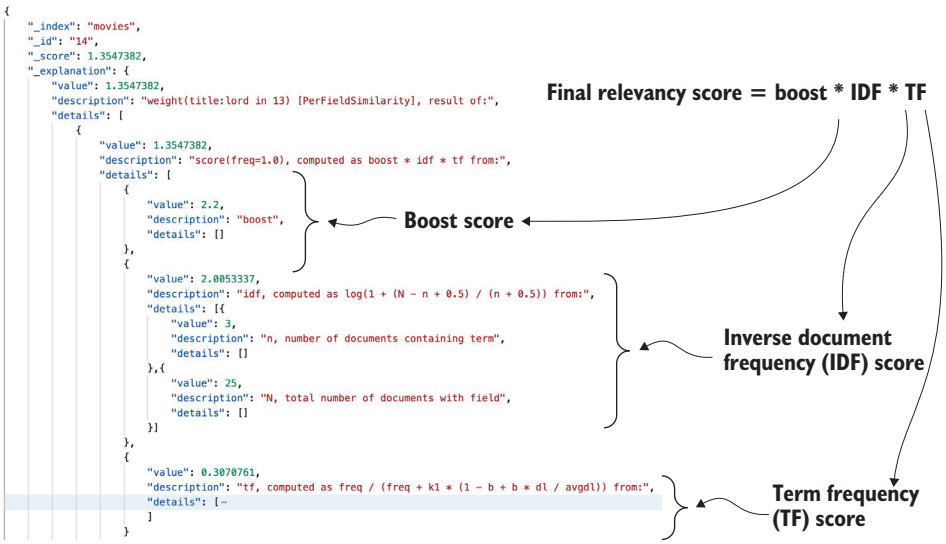



**Figure 8.5 The explanation of how Elasticsearch calculates relevancy scores**

The relevancy score is calculated by multiplying three components: the inverse document frequency (IDF), the term frequency (TF), and the boost factor. Elasticsearch goes into detail about how it evaluates and measures each of these components. For example, the `description` field in the return response shows that the IDF is computed as

```
log(1 + (N - n + 0.5) / (n + 0.5))
```

where

- *n* is the total number of documents containing the term (in figure 8.5, three documents contain the word *lord*).